

Cotter

Effective date: September 23, 2026

Cotter is a personal focus app: before it lets you open certain apps, it asks you to state your intent for that session. This page explains what information Cotter handles to do that, and where it goes.

01 What Cotter does

Cotter watches for when you open apps you've chosen to gate (for example, social media apps). When you open one, it shows a short prompt asking you to type what you intend to do in that app. That intent is checked for whether it's specific and genuine, and — if it looks good — you're let through.

02 Information we collect

- **The intent text you type** each time a gated app is opened.
- **Which app you were trying to open** (its package name), so past intents can be compared against the same app.
- **A local history of your recent intents**, stored only on your device, capped at the 50 most recent entries.

We do not collect your name, email, contacts, photos, precise location, or any account information — Cotter has no login system and no user accounts.

03 How your intent is checked

When you submit an intent, Cotter sends it — along with the name of the app you're opening and your recent past intents for that same app — to a small relay server we operate. That server forwards the text to Anthropic's Claude API, which checks whether your intent is specific and different from your recent past entries, and sends back a short yes/no result.

Third party involved

This validation step is processed by **Anthropic** (the company behind Claude). Only the text described above is sent — never your device identifiers, location, or any other app's data. See [Anthropic's privacy policy](#) for how they handle data sent to their API.

04 Where your data is stored

Your intent history lives locally on your device only, in the app's private storage. It is not backed up to any server we control, and we cannot see it. Uninstalling the app, or clearing its storage in your device settings, permanently deletes it.

The one exception is the brief validation step described above — that text passes through our relay server and Anthropic's API in order to generate a response, but our relay does not log or store it.

05 Permissions Cotter uses

- **Usage access** — to detect when you open one of the apps you've chosen to gate.
- **Display over other apps** — to show the intent prompt immediately, before the gated app's own screen appears.
- **Run at startup** — so gating resumes automatically after you restart your device, without you needing to reopen Cotter first.
- **Internet access** — to reach our relay server for the intent-check step described above.

None of these permissions are used to collect data beyond what's described in this policy.

06 Advertising and analytics

Cotter contains no advertising, no ad SDKs, and no analytics or tracking libraries. We don't know how many people use the app, how often, or for what — beyond what you can see about yourself in your own local intent history.

07 Your choices

- You can revoke Usage access or the overlay permission at any time in your device's Settings — Cotter will stop gating apps until you re-grant them.
- You can clear your local intent history at any time via your device's app storage settings, or by uninstalling the app.
- You can contact us with any question about your data, including a request to understand what's sent during a validation check, using the details below.

08 Children's privacy

Cotter is not directed at children, and we do not knowingly collect information from anyone under 13. If you believe a child has used the app and provided information through it, contact us and we'll address it.

09 Changes to this policy

If this policy changes, we'll update the effective date above. Continued use of the app after a change means you accept the updated policy.

10 Contact

Questions about this policy or your data can be sent to

nderituadrian1@gmail.com.
